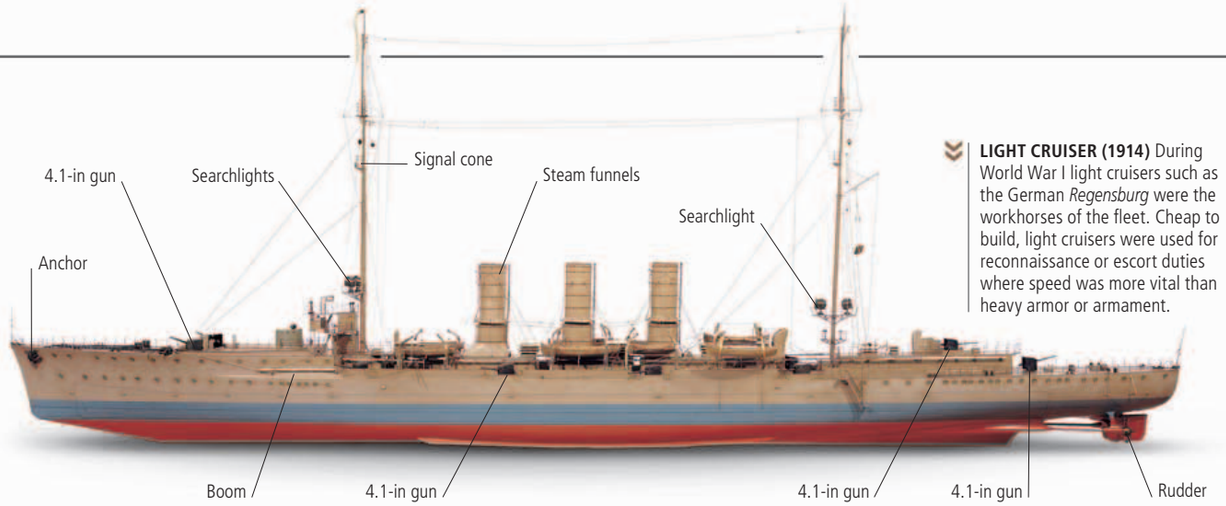
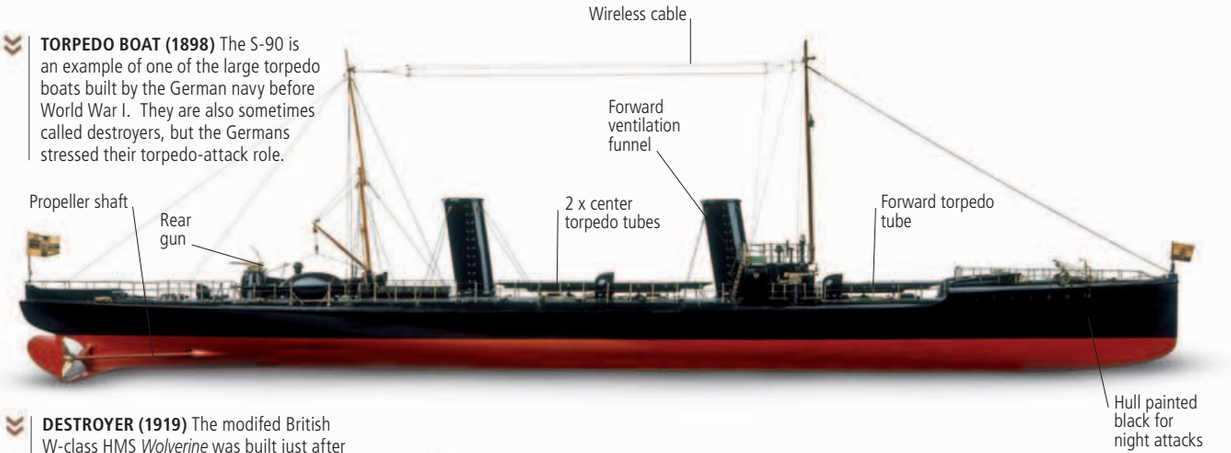
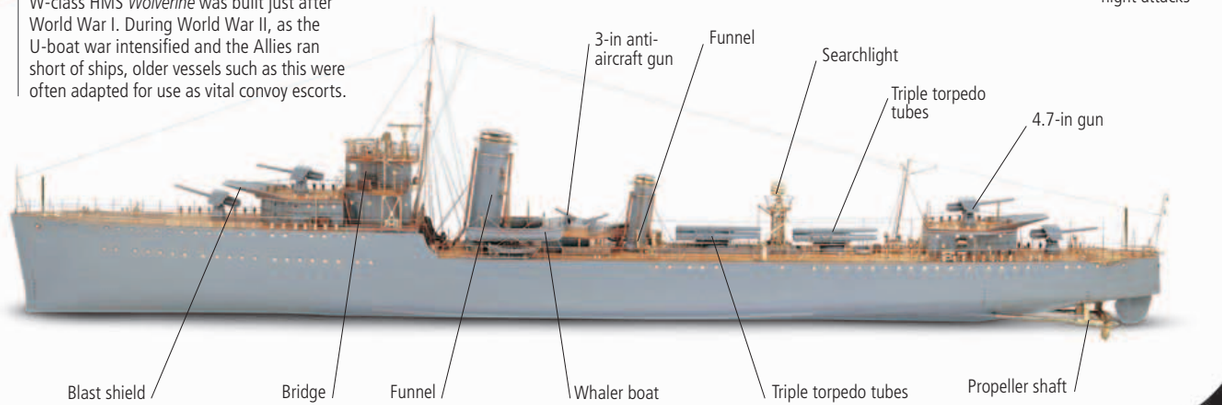


LIGHT CRUISER (1914) During World War I light cruisers such as the German *Regensburg* were the workhorses of the fleet. Cheap to build, light cruisers were used for reconnaissance or escort duties where speed was more vital than heavy armor or armament.



TORPEDO BOAT (1898) The S-90 is an example of one of the large torpedo boats built by the German navy before World War I. They are also sometimes called destroyers, but the Germans stressed their torpedo-attack role.



DESTROYER (1919) The modifed British W-class HMS *Wolverine* was built just after World War I. During World War II, as the U-boat war intensified and the Allies ran short of ships, older vessels such as this were often adapted for use as vital convoy escorts.

GLOSSARY

LINE AHEAD Ships sailing in a line, one behind another, are said to be "in line ahead."
MAN OF WAR Large sailing ship armed with cannon on two or three decks, the standard fighting ship of European navies from the 17th to the 19th century.
MANGONEL Medieval catapult, widely used in siege warfare.
MARINE Soldier carried on board a warship.
MARQUE, LETTERS OF License issued by a government to a privateer to engage warships or capture merchant shipping of another nation.
MATCH, SLOW Slow-burning cord used by gunners to light the priming powder in the touch-hole of a cannon.
MIDSHIPMAN Young boy taken aboard ship as a cadet to be trained up to be an officer.
MIZZEN MAST Third mast of a three-masted sailing ship, situated behind the mainmast. Often fitted with a lateen sail.
MONITOR Class of 19th-century ironclad warship that took its name from USS *Monitor*. Often applied to shallow-draft vessels used for shore bombardment.
MORTAR Muzzle-loading gun with a short, wide barrel for firing explosive shells at a high angle.
MUZZLE-LOADER Gun loaded from the front (muzzle) end, such as cannon where the shot and powder charge have to be rammed down the length of the barrel.
NAVARCH Supreme naval commander in Sparta and other Greek city-states.
NAUTICAL MILE 1.15 miles (1.85 km). 60 nautical miles = 1 degree of the earth's circumference.
OCTANT Precursor of the sextant as an instrument for measuring angle of sun, moon, and stars to the horizon.
PANOKSEON Medieval Korean war galley.
PENTECONTER Early Greek war galley, powered by 50 oars.
POLYREME Large oared galley of the Classical era with several oarsmen pulling on each oar.
POOP Highest deck of a sailing ship, situated at the stern, usually above the captain's quarters.

